

DESIGN ENHANCEMENT SPECIFICATION

Tamara AiQ Fluency Assessment

A complete UX and visual design guide to evolve the current prototype into a calm, credible, Tamara-branded internal assessment — without the visual noise of a marketing deck or a competitor dark theme.

Version: 1.0 · **Date:** 9 July 2026 · **Status:** For design & engineering alignment · **Baseline:** aiq_csuite static UI (brand.css, index.html, app.js)



Lavender #9600F1



Purple #5300BA



Mist #f2f2ff



Paper #fff



Ink #2a3051

Confidential — Internal Tamara. Companion to SRS Tamara AiQ v1.0.

1. Executive summary

1.1 Purpose

This document defines the **design enhancements** required to bring the Tamara AiQ Fluency Assessment from an internal prototype to a **pilot-ready product experience**. It covers visual identity application, information architecture, screen specifications, component standards, motion, accessibility, and a phased rollout plan for design and front-end implementation.

1.2 Design problem statement

The current UI (`static/brand.css` , `static/index.html`) correctly uses Tamara tokens but applies them at **maximum intensity**: full-bleed purple gradients, deck-style shadows, uppercase CTAs, six dimension chips during chat, and a dense results dashboard. For a ~10-minute reflective conversation, this creates:

- **Cognitive overload** — users process branding and assessment content at the same time.
- **Anxiety** — visual language feels like a test, launch event, or sales page.
- **Distrust of intent** — “Internal preview” + spectacle undermines the “reflection, not performance review” message.
- **Poor scan hierarchy** — everything competes at font-weight 800.

Design north star

Tamara AiQ should feel like a *thoughtful internal tool*: calm surfaces, one primary action per screen, lavender as punctuation — not wallpaper. The chat is the hero; brand is present but quiet.

1.3 What we are not doing

- Adopting AISA’s dark mode, neon accents, or certification/leaderboard energy.
- Replacing Tamara Visual Identity 2025 — we *refine application*, not rebrand.
- Adding decorative “slide numbers,” marketing stats, or social-proof tickers on the assessment path.

1.4 Success criteria (design)

Metric	Target	Method
Intro comprehension	≥ 90% understand “chat, ~10 min, not a test” in 5s	5-user hallway test
Visual calm rating	≥ 4/5 “feels calm / not stressful”	Post-session 1-question survey
Brand recognition	≥ 80% identify as Tamara without prompting	Moderated test
Chat focus	Dimension codes not required for users to complete flow	Task success
Results clarity	Users can state their score + top gap in < 30s on results screen	Moderated test
WCAG 2.1 AA	Pass on participant path	axe / manual audit

2. Design principles

#	Principle	Implication
1	Conversation first	Chat UI is minimal chrome; no rubric jargon visible during dialogue.
2	Calm over spectacle	White/mist backgrounds; one purple accent per view; no full-bleed gradients on functional screens.
3	Progressive disclosure	Intro → chat → scoring wait → staged results; never dump the full report at once.
4	Tamara, not template	Wordmark, lavender, Plus Jakarta Sans; avoid generic “AI SaaS” dark/neon tropes.
5	Respectful tone	Copy and UI avoid exam language, red alarm states, or “you failed” patterns.
6	Accessible by default	Contrast, focus rings, aria-live for new messages; 16px inputs on mobile.
7	Mobile-realistic	Many employees will use phone; chat composer and results must work at 320px width.

3. Brand application (Tamara Visual Identity 2025)

3.1 Color system — refined tokens

Keep official palette; change **roles**. Lavender is accent; surfaces are neutral.

Token	Hex	Role (new)	Old prototype misuse
--tam-lavender	#9600F1	Primary button, links, focus ring, active chip	Full-screen gradient endpoint
--zingy-purple	#5300BA	Headlines, secondary emphasis	Chat header gradient, user bubble fill
--surface-mist	#f2f2ff	Page background, subtle panels	Underused
--paper	#ffffff	Cards, chat area, modals	Competing with gradient
--ink	#2a3051	Body text	OK
--ink-muted	#444c6d	Secondary text	OK
--ink-soft	#707698	Hints, timestamps	OK
--border	#e0dcf0	Card borders, inputs	Replace heavy purple borders

Semantic colors (use sparingly): success `#059669`, warning `#d97706`, error `#b91c1c` — never for dimension scores (avoid traffic-light shame).

3.2 Typography

Element	Font	Size	Weight	Notes
Display (intro title)	Plus Jakarta Sans	28–32px	700	Not 800 everywhere
Section title	Plus Jakarta Sans	18–20px	600–700	Sentence case
Body	Plus Jakarta Sans	15–16px	400–500	Chat bubbles 16px min
Label / meta	Plus Jakarta Sans	12–13px	500–600	No ALL CAPS blocks > 3 words
Button	Plus Jakarta Sans	15–16px	600	Sentence case — “Begin assessment” not “BEGIN”

If Degular Display is licensed later, reserve it for *marketing landing only* — not in-chat UI.

3.3 Logo usage

- **Placement:** Top-left, small lockup (mark + “tamara” word), max height 24–28px in app chrome.
- **Intro:** Slightly larger (32–36px lockup) on white card — no gradient pill behind logo on every screen.
- **On purple:** White wordmark per brand rules; use only for optional thin top brand strip (max 48px height), not full header.
- **Never:** `filter: brightness(0)` on PNG; no stretched mark.

3.4 Elevation & shape

Level	Shadow	Use
0	none	Page background, chat messages area
1	0 1px 3px rgba(42,48,81,0.08)	Cards, composer
2	0 8px 24px rgba(42,48,81,0.10)	Modals only

Border radius: `12px` cards, `16px` bubbles, `999px` pills/chips. Retire `--shadow-slide` (0 24px 64px) on functional UI.

DO

White card on mist background; lavender CTA; small Tamara lockup.

DON'T

Full purple gradient page + gradient header + gradient user bubbles + deck shadow.

4. Competitive reference (patterns only)

Reference: AISA (aisa.to) and saved design screenshots in *AiQ Fluency Assessment Website / Pics For Design*. Extract **UX patterns**, not visual skin.

Pattern	AISA	Tamara adaptation
Pre-chat onboarding	5–6 steps, progress dots	2–3 steps max for pilot; light theme; no fake benchmark on step 1
Chat layout	Minimal chrome, dark	Same minimal chrome; light Tamara theme
Session status	“Solid report” pill + timer	“Building your picture” / timer — no report jargon mid-chat
Scoring wait	ETA + progress	Adopt — reduces anxiety during LLM scoring
Report reveal	5-slide story	Adopt structure; Tamara colors; no LinkedIn CTA in pilot
Percentile chart	Distribution + “You: 84”	Internal cohort only when $n \geq 30$; otherwise hide
Persona	“The Sceptic” etc.	Tamara persona set; softer typography, no rainbow gradient text

5. Information architecture

5.1 Site map (participant path)

1. **Welcome** → 2. **About you** (level, family, intent) → 3. **Chat** → 4. **Scoring** → 5. **Results story** (slides) → 6. **Full report** + PDF

5.2 What to hide from participants

- Dimension codes D1–D6 during chat (admin/orchestrator only).
- Weight percentages on first results view (show on “full breakdown”).
- “Internal preview” badge in production pilot (replace with “Tamara internal” or remove).
- Integrity / paste flags (admin only in pilot).

5.3 Content hierarchy per screen

Each screen gets **one primary question** in the user’s mind:

1. *Should I start?* → value + time + Begin
2. *Who am I for this run?* → level, family
3. *What do I say?* → single interviewer message + reply box
4. *Is it working?* → scoring progress
5. *How did I do?* → score + persona
6. *What next?* → gaps + actions + PDF

6. Screen specifications

6.1 Welcome (Screen A) PHASE 1

Layout

- Full viewport: `--surface-mist` background.
- Centered card max-width 480px, white, elevation 1.
- Tamara lockup top; no gradient bar.

Content (max)

Element	Copy direction
Title	"AiQ assessment" — sentence case subtitle: "A short chat about how you use AI at work."
Body	2 sentences max: not a form; ~10 minutes; end when ready.
Meta chips	3 quiet pills: "~10 min" · "Conversational" · "Private to this session"
CTA	Primary: "Continue" → Screen B

Remove from Screen A: 3 bullet expect list, bookmark URL warning, level/family dropdowns, "Internal preview" badge.

6.2 About you (Screen B) PHASE 1

- Progress: dot 2 of 3.
- Fields: Level (select), Job family (select).
- Optional: Intent — single select ("Growing in my role", "Leading a team", "Employer asked", "Curious").
- Footnote: one line privacy — "Transcript stored for L&D; don't paste customer data."
- CTA: "Start chat".

6.3 Chat (Screen C) PHASE 1

Chrome (minimal)

[tamara logo]8:42 [End session]

[subtle: Step 2 of 5 · Main scenario — optional phase label, not D1–D6]

[messages] [composer]

Header changes

Current	Target
Purple gradient .card-h	White bar, 1px bottom border
“In session” pill	Remove or replace with muted timer only
6 dimension chips	Remove from participant UI — use single phase label or thin progress bar (5 segments)
Wrap CTA box mid-chat	Replace with subtle text link when interviewer signals complete

Message bubbles

Role	Background	Border
Interviewer	#ffffff	1px #e0dcf0, optional 2px left lavender accent
Participant	#f0e8ff or #ede5ff (light lavender tint)	none; no dark purple gradient

Phase shift banner

Keep but simplify: “Next: When something goes wrong” — no D4 code, no uppercase NEXT TOPIC.

Composer

- Placeholder: “Type your reply...”
- Single Send button; sentence case.
- Secondary: “End session” as text link in header, not duplicate in footer.
- Remove keyboard hint from default view (tooltip or help icon).

6.4 Scoring wait (Screen D) PHASE 2

Full-screen white/mist overlay after user taps End session.

- Headline: “Reviewing your conversation...”
- Sub: “This usually takes under a minute.”
- Indeterminate or staged progress bar (lavender).
- No “challenge a friend” in internal pilot.
- On failure: calm retry button; preserve Tamara tone.

6.5 Results story — slides (Screen E) PHASE 2

Five slides, dot navigation, “Skip to full report” always visible.

Slide	Content	Visual
E1	"Your results are ready."	Small Tamara mark; no drum-roll gimmick
E2	AiQ score /100 + maturity band + persona name	Large numeral; band as soft pill
E3	6 dimensions — simple bar chart	Horizontal bars; names not codes
E4	Top 2 gaps + one evidence quote each	Quote in italic block
E5	Next steps (3 bullets) + Download PDF	Primary CTA lavender

6.6 Full report (Screen F) PHASE 1

Evolve current `report-onepage` — simplify first paint:

- 1. **Hero row:** Score + band + 2-line summary only.
- 2. **Accordion or tabs:** Dimensions | Coaching | Learning links.
- 3. **Remove on first load:** Radar chart (optional expand), benchmark scale if cohort < 30.

6.7 End session modal PHASE 1

- Keep modal pattern; reduce stat grid unless readiness API returns meaningful breadth.
- Title: "Finish and see your summary?"
- Buttons: "Keep chatting" (secondary) · "See my summary" (primary).
- Loading state inside modal → transition to Screen D.

7. Component library

7.1 Buttons

Variant	Style
Primary	bg lavender, white text, radius 10px, padding 12px 20px, weight 600
Secondary	white bg, lavender border 1.5px, lavender text
Ghost / link	lavender text, no uppercase, underline on hover
Disabled	opacity 0.45; no transform hover

7.2 Form controls

- Select: white bg, `--border`, focus ring 3px lavender 20% alpha.
- Textarea: min-height 48px; radius 12px; no 2px heavy purple border default.

7.3 Chips / pills

- Meta chips (intro): grey bg `#f4f3f8`, ink-muted text.
- Active phase: lavender outline, not filled purple chip farm.

7.4 Score display

- Composite: 48–56px numeral, ink color — not gradient fill.
- Dimension row: label left, bar center, score right — one row per dimension in full report.
- Avoid red/green score coloring; use lavender bar fill only.

7.5 Empty / loading / error

State	Treatment
LLM typing	Three soft dots, lavender — “Thinking...”
API error	Rose-tinted banner, plain language, retry
Session ended	Neutral message + link to start new

8. Motion & interaction

- **Message in:** fade + 4px translateY, 200ms ease-out.
- **Slide transition:** 250ms horizontal fade (results story).
- **No:** pulse animations on “View results” link; parallax; hero number count-up (optional subtle only on slide E2).
- **Respect prefers-reduced-motion:** disable transforms.

9. Accessibility

Requirement	Implementation
Contrast	Body text $\geq 4.5:1$ on white; lavender buttons white text OK at #9600F1
Focus	Visible 3px focus ring on all interactive elements
Live regions	<code>aria-live="polite"</code> on new interviewer messages
Modal	Focus trap, Escape closes, return focus to trigger
Touch targets	Min 44×44px
Mobile inputs	16px font in textarea (prevent iOS zoom) — keep

10. Responsive behavior

Breakpoint	Behavior
< 480px	Full-width card; composer stack (textarea then full-width Send)
480–768px	Default; max-width 520px chat column centered
> 768px	Same max-width — do not stretch chat to full desktop width

11. Admin & orchestrator UI

Lower priority for pilot polish but should not clash:

- Reuse calm tokens; admin may keep slightly denser tables.
- White `.deck-card` panels on mist — remove admin hero white text on purple gradient.
- Telemetry charts: neutral greys; lavender for highlights only.

12. PDF & print

- Session PDF: match Screen F content; Tamara logo header strip lavender 4px top rule.
- Print stylesheet: strip chrome, white background — extend existing `@media print` rules.
- Executive deck (`/deck/executive`): may stay richer for board — separate from app UI tokens.

13. Implementation mapping

File	Changes
<code>static/brand.css</code>	New “calm theme” tokens; deprecate body gradient; simplify <code>.card-h</code> , <code>.bubble.me</code> , <code>.aiq-progress</code>
<code>static/index.html</code>	Split intro steps; simplify chat chrome; add scoring + slides containers
<code>static/app.js</code>	Wizard navigation; hide D-chips; results slide controller; scoring overlay
<code>static/brand/*</code>	Verify wordmark assets per README

14. Phased delivery

Phase 1 — Calm foundation 1–2 WEEKS

- White/mist page background; remove full-bleed gradient
- White chat header; light participant bubbles
- Sentence-case buttons; reduce font-weight 800 usage
- Split intro: Welcome + About you

- Hide dimension chips from chat; phase label only
- Simplify results hero (score first; accordion for rest)
- Remove “Internal preview” badge for pilot build

Phase 2 — Journey polish 2–3 WEEKS

- Scoring wait screen (Screen D)
- 5-slide results story (Screen E)
- Persona card on slide E2
- Intent capture on Screen B
- WCAG audit fixes

Phase 3 — Refinement ONGOING

- Internal benchmark chart when cohort sufficient
- Admin UI calm pass
- Arabic RTL exploration
- Figma component library synced to code tokens

15. Design deliverables checklist

Deliverable	Owner	Phase
Figma: 6 participant screens (A–F)	Design	1–2
Component spec (buttons, inputs, bubbles)	Design	1
Copy deck (all UI strings)	Product + People	1
Brand review sign-off	Brand team	1
Implemented calm theme in brand.css	Engineering	1
5-slide results in app.js	Engineering	2
Moderated usability test (n=5)	Product	2

16. Open design decisions

#	Question	Recommendation
DD-01	Top brand strip purple vs all-white chrome?	All-white chrome for pilot
DD-02	Show phase names to users?	Yes — human labels only
DD-03	Radar chart in report?	Behind “Show chart” expand
DD-04	Persona visual treatment	Text + icon, no rainbow gradient
DD-05	Dark mode	Defer — not Tamara app standard

Summary

The enhancement is not a rebrand — it is *restraint*. Tamara AiQ should read as a trusted internal conversation tool: white space, lavender accents, progressive disclosure, and copy that lowers stakes. Implement Phase 1 before any new assessment features; visual calm is a pilot requirement, not polish.